

10.1 Taking your application further

Facebook platform also supports various resources that help you analyze your application statistics, where to go if you get stuck, and, perhaps most important, how to generate a revenue stream from your application! A lot of applications generate a good revenue stream from advertisements and with some planning and some good choices, you should be able to at least offset the costs of your server hosting, if not turn into a millionaire.

10.1.1 Application Statistics

There is a basic statistics feature in the Facebook Developer application to help you get an idea of what's going on with your application by giving you detailed stats on usage, HTTP status requests, and recent HTTP requests. You are also provided with a helpful User Engagement statistic that tells you how many people have used your application in the past 24 hours. This helps you figure out how many people are actually "using" your application.

But, if you need or want more sophisticated statistics, the `<fb:googleanalytics>` tag comes in handy. Create an account on Google Analytics to use this tag and it will provide you with exceptionally detailed statistics about your application (and for that matter, any web site build). Navigate to <http://www.google.com/analytics/> and sign in with your Google account to use Google Analytics. Add a web site profile by clicking on the Add Website Profile link to start the process. Next, fill out the form for a new domain using your server address URL (not your `http://apps.facebook.com/<your_app_name>` URL) and click on continue. You will now be presented with a small snippet of JavaScript to add to your page. But it's not FBJS. So, you cannot add it directly. Just get the account number (defined by the `_uacct` variable) from that code to use the `<fb:google-analytics>` tag, and let Facebook write this in for you.

Add the following code in your application to produce the required JavaScript in your application:

```
<fb:google-analytics    uacct="<your_UA_account_number>"
/>
```

Facebook will automatically correct and add the JavaScript to the resultant HTML stream. You will also have access to the Google Analytics tracker in FBJS with the `Facebook.urchinTracker` object in case you want it. `<fb:google-analytics>` tag is the easiest way to implement your own methods through FBJS; however, if you should you need more granular control over what gets sent to the Google servers for your application, the functionality does exist.